

## Internship Reflection

**1) Provide a brief overview of the internship, the number of hours worked, and what you did.**

- a) The internship that I had gotten approved to do was my current job at Gyu Kaku Japanese BBQ Downtown San Jose. To give some insight, I had already worked here prior to my internship as a lead server but had asked my general manager and other managers to take me under their wing to show me a little bit more of behind the scenes and managerial responsibilities. Over the course of this internship, I worked approximately over 140 hours, as this is just an estimate of how many hours I had worked over the summer and a little before that. On top of my current responsibilities of front-of-house operations, I learned new tasks that involved restaurant operations, management, and marketing. I observed and participated in ordering food through vendors and cost considerations. I also learned more about how Gyu Kaku markets their items through seasonal courses and promoted new menu times to loyalty app guests. We have a mobile app system that I also promoted and marketed to many customers to get sign ups and understood the managerial side to it. This dual role to which I consider an internship since I stayed longer hours to learn allowed me to connect day-to-day service with the larger business strategy of running a successful restaurant.

**2) What were some of the new things that you learned during this internship?**

a) With this role, I gained several insights beyond the scope of my prior role as a lead server. I learned a lot more about marketing knowledge and operational processes such as ordering food and inventory management. For example, Gyu Kaku promotes seasonal items such as our Flavors of Japan menu to encourage customers to try our new items. Compared to other BBQ places I am aware of, they tend to keep their menu static and do not change. At Gyu Kaku, I took the manager course to learn about how these courses are designed to attract customers and how the overall use of our loyalty program attracts customers to return. My manager let me look at some charts that demonstrated our Sprinklr score and also the amount of sign ups that were obtained throughout all locations of Gyu Kaku. I also learned more about ordering inventory and how much of what to order. Every Sunday, my managers and I would weigh food and count alcohol in order to log it into an inventory sheet. This sheet would then be looked over and we would decide how much of what items to order from our vendor Sysco. Shipments came in every Thursday and I was in charge of signing the shipment and counting the items. There was also another paper where I logged losses that would have to be logged into the system such as expired food or food that was dropped for example. Another thing I took into consideration was shelf life, for example orange juice I did not order a lot of in bulk because it expired quickly and buying in bulk would mean that a lot of it would be expired and not used. Overall I was basically a manager this summer and my managers even asked if I wanted to be moved up.

**3) What were some things that surprised you?**

a) Something that surprised me was how much there goes on behind the scenes of a restaurant. I will not lie, the inventory counting, the emails I had to send, and the budgeting when ordering food was quite stressful. As a server prior, I had only focused on service but taking upon more responsibilities during this internship allowed me to realize how much work has to be done behind the scenes. Another thing I found intriguing was overall data of loyalty sign ups and daily sales and food waste tracking. These all affect many aspects of the restaurant and were central to evaluating campaigns, meetings, and planning inventory when it was time to order. I was also in charge of calling places like ECOlab to do routine clean ups at the restaurant. This was something I thought GYU KAKU higher ups would send but it was up to the managers to make sure these things get done.

**4) How will you use the learnings from this internship to position yourself for a job interview? I.e. What have you learned to do well due to your experience?**

a) I can confidently say that I have specialized in leadership and training through this internship. I was in charge of interviewing some people and also printing out documents and logging it in order to upload it to the cloud server. I have experience in training others and also experience in ordering inventory online through vendors. I can also confidently say that I am really good at upselling and understanding the purpose of loyalty system programs. On many occasions I see many returning customers asking for me. I now understand the restaurant industry beyond just serving, which equipped me for a better role in management or even corporate level roles.

**5) Are there any specific insights or observations related to the EMPAC model that you learned during your internship?**

- a) Entertainment- Our dining experience was unique as guests were allowed to cook their own food which makes it overall interactive and memorable. We also do smores which is something most BBQ places do not do as they just provide ice cream. Our dishes are also designated to give customers a show such as us mixing up the Sukiyaki Bimbipaps.
- b) Matching- Our menu is tailored to different groups of people. We have a vegetarian menu, a seafood menu, a meat menu, a kids menu, and even course menus to tailor to head counts. We also have birthday specials such as free dessert and us singing which attracts people who want to come for their birthdays. We also have gluten free options which are clearly labeled in our menu.
- c) Price/ Promotion- I observed how to profit promotions with profitability. We had many promotions that offered discounts for customers to come back.
- d) Assortment: We had seasonal menu items such as Matcha Fondue smores and Hokkaido scallops
- e) Convenience: We recently switched over to toast to make operations easier and payments easier as well. The loyalty app system was also very easy to sign up and use which allowed customers to be more inclined to come back.